

COVERS LOGIC PRO 11 AND 12

LOGIC PRO CRASH COURSE

265 TRICKS THAT ACTUALLY WORK

CHECKED AGAINST APPLE'S DOCUMENTATION. ANYTHING UNCONFIRMED WAS CUT.

265

TRICKS

19

SECTIONS

100%

CLICKABLE

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EVERY ENTRY IS A LINK. CLICK IT AND YOU ARE THERE.

START HERE

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Do not read this front to back. Jump to the section that matches what you are stuck on right now, take the trick, and get back to the music. Every section is one click away from every page.

Each entry is short on purpose. Title, what it does, the key command. Ten seconds to read, yours for good.

-
- Every key command shown is the Logic Pro factory default on a US keyboard. If you have remapped anything, open Key Commands with `⌘K` and search the command name — the name is always given.
-
- Where a trick lives in a menu rather than on a key, the full menu path is written out, so it stays correct across versions.
-
- This edition covers Logic Pro 11 and 12. Earlier versions differ in ways that would make some of these wrong — 10.7 calls Settings “Preferences” and the View pane “Display”, among others — so it is not written for them.
-
- Every claim was checked against Apple’s Logic Pro documentation, or against two independent sources where Apple is silent. Anything that failed was corrected; anything that could not be confirmed was cut rather than printed on a guess.
-
- Tricks marked GAME CHANGER are the ones worth stealing first.
-

— Nothing here requires third-party plugins. It is all stock Logic.

THE ONE HABIT THAT MATTERS MOST

Every time you catch yourself doing something with the mouse for the third time, check whether it has a key command. If it does, learn it. If it does not, make one. That single habit is worth more than any individual trick in this book.

REFERENCE

KEY LEGEND

Logic's documentation and this book both use the Mac modifier symbols. If you are coming from another DAW, this is the page to bookmark.



The workhorse. Most structural commands.



Almost always means copy, all, or alternate behaviour.



Extends a selection or reverses a command.



Fine adjustments, and secondary click.



Sends the playhead to the start of the project.



Removes the selection.



SPACE

Play / Stop. The most used key in the program.

THREE MODIFIER RULES THAT EXPLAIN MOST OF LOGIC

Hold $\neg$ while dragging anything and you copy it instead of moving it. Hold $\neg$ while clicking a knob or fader and it resets to its default. $\neg$ -click a Solo button and it becomes an exclusive solo — that channel alone. Learn these three and you can guess your way through most of the program.

LEARN THESE FIRST

THE BASIC KEY COMMANDS

If you learn nothing else, learn this page. These are the commands you will use hundreds of times a day, and they are the foundation every other section builds on.

TRANSPORT

SPACE	Play / Stop
↶	Go to beginning of project
R	Record
C	Cycle on / off
K	Metronome on / off
⌘.	Stop and discard the recording just made
U	Set locators by selected regions
/	Open the Go to Position dialog

WINDOWS AND VIEWS



Show / hide Mixer



Show / hide Piano Roll



Show / hide Editor



Show / hide Score Editor



Show / hide Library



Show / hide Loop Browser



Show / hide Browsers



Show / hide Smart Controls



Show / hide Inspector



Show / hide Global Tracks



Hide / show all plug-in windows

EDITING

⌘ Z	Undo
⇧ ⌘ Z	Redo
⌘ T	Split regions at playhead
⌘ J	Join selected regions
⌘ R	Repeat regions or events
⌘ D	New track with duplicate settings
⌘ A	Select all
⇧ ⌘ A	Deselect all
⌘ + DRAG	Copy instead of move
⌘ + DRAG	Marquee select (default secondary tool)

ZOOM AND NAVIGATION

Z	Zoom to fit selection, press again to return
⌘ ← / ⌘ →	Zoom out / in horizontally
⌘ ↑ / ⌘ ↓	Zoom out / in vertically
^ ⌘ + DRAG	Drag-zoom to any area

CAPTURE AND OUTPUT

⌘ R	Flashback Capture — grab what you just played
⌘ S	Save
⇧ ⌘ S	Save as
⌘ B	Bounce project or section
^ B	Bounce regions in place
⌘ K	Open Key Commands
⌘ ,	Open Settings

SECTION 01

SETTING UP MY PREFERRED SETTINGS.

30 TRICKS

Before a single note goes down, get the program out of your way. This is the longest section in the book on purpose — an hour spent here saves you a hundred hours later. Everything below is a setting I change on every fresh install.

AUDIO PREFERENCES

LOGIC PRO > SETTINGS > AUDIO

001 GAME CHANGER

Run two buffer sizes, not one

Set I/O Buffer to 64 or 128 while tracking so you can play in time, then switch to 512 or 1024 when you mix so plugins stop crackling. Nothing else in Logic changes your day this much.

⌘,

002

Set Processing Threads to Automatic

Manually pinning thread counts was useful a decade ago. On Apple silicon, Automatic consistently beats hand tuning. Leave it alone.

003

Enable Multithreading on Playback Tracks

Settings > Audio > Devices — set Multithreading to "Playback & Live Tracks" if you want live, record-enabled tracks spread across cores. "Playback Tracks" is the older behaviour: all live input DSP is handled by a single thread on a single core. Apple notes "Playback & Live Tracks" places slightly more overall load on the system, so if you have no demanding live tracks, "Playback Tracks" is the better choice.

004

Raise Process Buffer Range to Large for mixing

This is separate from the I/O buffer and it buys you real headroom on plugin-heavy projects. Drop it back to Small only if you notice sluggish response.

005

Uncheck Software Monitoring if you monitor through your interface

If your interface has zero-latency direct monitoring, Logic's software monitoring just adds a second, slightly late copy of your voice. Turn it off and the doubling disappears.

RECORDING PREFERENCES

LOGIC PRO > SETTINGS > RECORDING

006

Turn off “Allow Quick Punch-In” only if you never punch

Leave it on. Turn it on at Record > Allow Quick Punch-In (or Control-click the Record button in the control bar and choose it there). With it on, start playback and hit the Record Toggle key command at the moment you want to drop in — the transition happens with no audible gap and the recording before and after the punched section is untouched, which is a lifesaver when a take suddenly gets good.

007

Set the click source to a sound you can actually hear

Open File > Project Settings > Metronome. The click is the Klopfggeist plug-in sitting on the Click channel strip, and every part of it is yours: raise the Bar velocity above the Beat velocity so the downbeat actually lands, and change the Note values to pitch the click somewhere it cuts through your mix. Want a different sound entirely? Load any instrument you like onto the Click channel strip and drive it with those same note numbers. A click you have to strain for is a click you will drift against.

MIDI PREFERENCES

LOGIC PRO > SETTINGS > MIDI

008

Turn on scrubbing with audio in the Tracks area

Settings > Audio > Editing > “Scrubbing with audio in Tracks area”. With it on you can drag the playhead over audio and hear it, which makes finding a spot by ear possible.

009

Set the MIDI reset options to send Notes Off only

Leave the MIDI Reset Messages alone. Under Settings > MIDI > Reset Messages every box is unselected by default and Apple's guidance is to keep it that way — Logic handles MIDI reset messages automatically. The Control 123 (All Notes Off) and Control 121 (Reset Controls) options are there only for compatibility with older hardware; switch one on only if a specific old synth needs it.

010

Fix doubled notes from a controller

If your synth plays a doubled, slightly flammed note on every key press, turn Local Control off on the synth, or use Project Settings > MIDI > General > “Instrument Without MIDI Thru Function”. One or the other, never neither.

011

GAME CHANGER

Turn on Enable Complete Features first, always

Settings > Advanced > Enable Complete Features. It is one checkbox. Leave it off and Logic runs in Simplified mode with whole areas hidden — project alternatives, beat mapping, the full mixer and automation.

012

Turn off region colouring by track and colour by region instead

Under Settings > View > Tracks, set the Region Color pop-up to "Individual" rather than "As Track Color". Individual lets you colour-code by part rather than by track, which scales much better on big arrangements — and if you switch back and forth, Logic remembers each region's individual colour.

013

Turn on "Show Help Tags"

Help tags show exact position, length and delta values while you drag. They are how you edit precisely without opening a single numeric field.

014

Set Cycle to "Auto-set locators by region selection"

Control-click the Cycle button in the control bar and turn on Auto Set Locators > by Region Selection. Now selecting a region snaps the locators and the cycle area to that region's borders, so C loops exactly what you picked. It turns cycle into a one-key operation.

015

Turn on "Select regions on track selection"

Small setting, enormous effect. Clicking a track header selects that track's regions, so every region command becomes a two-step operation instead of a hunt.

016

GAME CHANGER

Set “Limit Dragging to One Direction” to Vertically in the Tracks area

Tick the “Limit Dragging to One Direction: In Tracks” checkbox in Logic Pro > Settings > General > Editing. Once you start a drag left or right, movement locks to the horizontal axis, so you cannot nudge a perfectly placed region onto another track by accident. To actually change tracks, let go, reselect, and drag up or down — or hold Shift to override the limit for one move. There is a matching checkbox for the Piano Roll and Score.

017

Read the Clean Up list before you confirm it

File > Project Management > Clean Up always asks first and shows exactly what it will remove. Read the list — it deletes whole unused audio files, not just unused portions of them.

PROJECT SETTINGS

FILE > PROJECT SETTINGS

018

Set your sample rate before you record, not after

Under File > Project Settings > Audio, pick 48 kHz for anything that might touch video and 44.1 kHz for pure music (48 kHz is Logic's default on a fresh install). Change it after you have recorded or imported audio and Logic does not resample those files for you — they play back at the wrong pitch and speed. If you genuinely must convert, use File > Project Settings > Assets and select “Convert audio file sample rate when importing”.

019

Set the recording bit depth to 24-bit

It lives in Settings > Recording, not Project Settings. 32-bit float is available from Logic Pro 10.8 (November 2023) onward and depends on your interface. Never record at 16-bit.

020

GAME CHANGER

Turn on Smart Tempo “Keep Project Tempo” by default

Under Project Settings > Smart Tempo, set the project mode to Keep. Adaptive mode is powerful but it will rewrite your tempo map from a single dragged-in loop if you are not paying attention.

021

Stop new recordings arriving pre-quantised

There is no auto-quantize switch. The default applied to new recordings is the Region inspector's Quantize value with no region selected — set it to off there. Capture the performance first; quantise as a decision.

022

Set Tuning to Equal Temperament unless you mean otherwise

Project Settings > Tuning quietly affects every software instrument. If a synth sounds subtly wrong against a sample, check here first.

023

Turn on “Bounce project settings” for consistent exports

Retitle to “Copy your assets into the project so it travels”. Under File > Project Settings > Assets, tick the options to copy audio files, Ultrabeat and Sampler samples, Space Designer impulse responses and Apple Sound Library content into the project. The files are copied in the next time you save, and from then on you can move or copy the project without breaking a single file reference. Your project becomes portable in one move.

DEFAULTS, TEMPLATES AND HOUSEKEEPING

024

GAME CHANGER

Save a Session Start template and set it as the default

Build one project with your usual tracks, buses, reverb and marker colours, then File > Save as Template. Set it to open on launch and you never build a session from zero again.

025

Set a default channel strip for new tracks

Build one channel strip the way you always want to start — gain staging, your go-to EQ and compressor, the sends you always use. Click the Setting button at the top of the strip and choose “Save Channel Strip Setting As”, and file it somewhere you will find it. From then on, every new track is two clicks from your starting point: open the Library, find your saved setting under User Channel Strip Settings, click it. Keeping a copy of that strip in your template gets you the same result with no clicks at all.

026

Set the default region colour palette

Press `⌘C` to open the Color palette (or Control-click a region and choose Name and Color > Show/Hide Colors). Double-click any swatch to open the Colors window and dial in a custom colour with the wheel and the contrast and opacity sliders. Decide once what each colour means to you — drums, vocals, keys, reference — and build that scheme into your template so every project opens with the same language. Consistent colours across projects make navigating an old session instant.

027

Turn on Project Alternatives before you need them

File > Project Alternatives > New Alternative gives you branching versions inside one project file — name it and click Done. Make one before every big arrangement change. (You will only see the menu if Enable Complete Features is switched on in Settings > Advanced.) The same menu's Edit Alternatives lets you rename or remove them; the Main alternative cannot be removed.

028

Set autosave and then still hit `⌘S`

Retitle to "Logic autosaves — still hit `⌘S`". Logic autosaves invisibly so you do not lose work if it quits unexpectedly, but there is no autosave setting to turn on or tune, and you will only ever meet it as a recovery prompt after a crash. What you control is `⌘S`: every manual save also banks a backup of the current alternative (up to ten), reachable from File > Revert To. Build the reflex of hitting `⌘S` every time you finish a thought.



029

Move the Sound Library to an external drive on purpose

Logic Pro > Sound Library > Relocate Sound Library lets you move tens of gigabytes off your system drive without breaking a single patch.

030

Set the audio file location to "Project" not "Folder"

Retitle to "Set the audio file location to 'Package' not 'Folder'". In the File > Save As dialog, choose "Organize my project as: Package". Keeping recorded audio inside the project package means dragging one file to a hard drive moves everything. Only switch to Folder if you are working with an enormous session across multiple drives.

SECTION 02

ARRANGEMENT TRICKS.

15 TRICKS

Arranging is mostly moving big blocks of time around without breaking anything. These tricks let you restructure a whole song in seconds instead of dragging regions one by one and praying.

MOVING TIME, NOT REGIONS

031 **GAME CHANGER**

Use the Arrangement track to move whole sections

Open Global Tracks with G, enable the Arrangement track, and drop markers on your Verse, Chorus and Bridge. Now drag the Chorus marker and the entire section — every track, every automation point — moves with it.

G

032

⌘-drag one arrangement marker onto another to swap sections

A plain drag moves a section, or inserts it between two others. To swap two sections outright, drag one arrangement marker directly over another — the two markers switch places and all their content is swapped. Trying three song orders takes about fifteen seconds.

⌘ + DRAG

033

⌘-drag an arrangement marker to duplicate a section

Hold ⌘ and drag any arrangement marker to copy that entire section, contents and all, to a new point in the timeline.

⌘ + DRAG

034

Delete a section and close the gap

Select the arrangement marker and press Delete once — that removes the section's regions. Press Delete again and the marker goes too, pulling everything after it back to close the hole.

035

Insert silence across the whole project

Set the locators, then Edit > Cut/Insert Time > Insert Silence Between Locators. Every track and every automation point shifts. This is how you add two bars to an intro without wrecking the mix.

036

Snap arrangement markers to your actual section boundaries

New arrangement markers always appear at the start of the project or after the last existing marker, eight bars long, regardless of where the playhead or locators sit. So create the marker first, then drag its right edge to the exact end of the section — the edge snaps to bars, so it lands on the boundary rather than near it.

U

BUILDING AND DUPLICATING

037

Convert loops to real regions only at the very end

Edit > Convert > Loops to Aliases turns software-instrument loop repetitions into aliases and audio loop repeats into cloned audio regions. Stay looped as long as possible so a single edit propagates, then convert once the arrangement is locked.

038

Use aliases for parts that must stay identical

⌘⇧-drag a MIDI region to create an alias. Edit the parent and every alias follows. Perfect for doubled parts across a whole song.

⌘⇧ + DRAG

039

Make a folder out of a section

Select every region in a section and use Functions > Folder > Pack Folder. The arrangement collapses to one block you can move, copy and mute as a unit.

040

GAME CHANGER

Colour-code sections, not instruments

Open the colour palette with ⌘C and give every chorus the same colour across all tracks. You can then read the arrangement at a glance from fully zoomed out.

⌘C

JUDGING THE ARRANGEMENT

041

Use Track Stacks to collapse instrument families

Select related tracks and hit ⇧⌘D, then choose Summing Stack in the dialog. Drums become one lane and the arrangement becomes readable.

⇧⌘D

042

Solo an arrangement section with the locators

Select the regions that make up the section, then press U. That single key is Set Rounded Locators by Regions/Events and Enable Cycle — it rounds the locators to the nearest barlines around your selection and switches Cycle mode on in one go. Don't press C afterwards; that would switch Cycle back off.

U

043

Mute regions instead of deleting them while experimenting

Click a region with the Mute tool, or select the regions and press Control-M. Muted regions turn grey with a dot before the name, so arrangement experiments become reversible without touching undo.

M

045

Use markers for notes to self, not just sections

Create a marker from the Global Tracks marker lane, then rename it "fix snare here" or "vocal comp needed". Your to-do list lives on the timeline instead of on paper.

044

GAME CHANGER

Keep a "graveyard" track at the bottom

Make one muted, hidden track and drag every rejected idea onto it. Nothing is ever deleted, and the good version of that rejected idea is there when you need it three weeks later.

SECTION 03

NAVIGATING TRICKS.

6 TRICKS

The shortest section in the book, and possibly the highest value per word. Getting the playhead and the view where you want them, instantly, is the difference between working and fiddling.

046

Drag-zoom to any area with $\hat{_}$

Hold $\hat{_}$ and drag a box around any part of the arrangement to zoom straight to it. Hold $\hat{_}$ and click empty space to zoom back out.

$\hat{_}$ + DRAG

047

Know what the number keys actually do

The top-row number keys recall screensets, not markers — Apple's guide says you recall a screenset by pressing any numeric key except 0, so 1–9 switch window layouts. If you want marker jumps on a key, open Key Commands ($_K$) and search "Go to Marker Number" — there are 20 of them, numbered by the order the markers appear in the project.

048

Assign a key to "Play Selection"

Open Key Commands with $_K$ and search "Selection". Logic has several selection-based playback commands — Play from Selection is on $\hat{\text{Space}}$ by default and starts playback at the beginning of whatever you have selected — so you can audition just the part you are working on. Browse the list and put the one that matches your workflow on a key you can reach.

049

Scroll horizontally without the scrollbar

Two-finger swipe left and right on a trackpad to move through the project. Apple documents gesture scrolling in the Tracks area, and dragging two fingers scrolls a pane horizontally as well as vertically — keep your hand off the scrollbar entirely.

050

Use the Cycle area as a bookmark

Select the region or passage you are working on and press U. Logic sets the left and right locators around it — rounded to bar lines — and turns Cycle on, so the yellow strip in the ruler marks your work area and keeps looping it. Use $\mathbb{U}$ instead if you want the locators exactly on the selection boundaries rather than rounded.

051

Toggle Catch to stop the screen running away

The Catch button makes the view follow the playhead. Click it off when you are doing detailed editing and the view will hold still while the song plays. You do not need to assign anything — Catch Playhead Position is already on the backquote (``) key, so you can toggle it without leaving the keyboard.

$_K$ TO ASSIGN

SECTION 04

COMPOSING MIDI TRICKS.

13 TRICKS

Getting ideas out of your head and into the sequencer before they evaporate. These tricks are about speed of capture first and correctness second — you can always fix it later, but you cannot un-forget an idea.

CAPTURE WITHOUT A KEYBOARD

052

GAME CHANGER

Capture the last thing you played, even when not recording

If you played something great while the transport was rolling but not recording, hit ↑ R and Logic writes it to a region retroactively. MIDI works on any recent version, whether the project is playing or stopped. Audio needs Logic 11.2 or later: make sure the audio track is in focus and the transport is playing — Logic captures only while there is an incoming signal, needs at least four seconds of playback, and can save up to one minute of audio.

↑ R

053

Use the Step Input Keyboard for parts you cannot play

Window > Show Step Input Keyboard. Enter notes one at a time at an exact rhythmic value. Complex parts get entered accurately without a single quantise pass.

054

Draw notes with the Pencil, delete with the Eraser

The Pencil creates a note whose length, velocity and MIDI channel match the last note you created or edited. To remove a note, select it and press Delete, or click it with the Eraser tool. ⌘-drag a note to copy it to a new position.

CHORDS, SCALES AND HARMONY

055

GAME CHANGER

Use the Chord Trigger MIDI plugin to play chords with one finger

Insert Chord Trigger in the MIDI FX slot and click Learn. Click the trigger key you want on the upper keyboard first, then click the notes of the chord on the lower keyboard, then click Learn again to finish. Whole progressions become one-finger performances.

056

Force everything into key with Transposer's scale quantize

Insert the Transposer MIDI FX and set its Root and Scale pop-up menus. Transposer transposes incoming MIDI notes in real time and corrects them to the selected scale, so every wrong note you play is pulled to the nearest right one as you play. Pick User and switch notes off on the on-screen keyboard to build your own scale.

057

Use Arpeggiator to generate parts, then commit them

Insert Arpeggiator and dial in a pattern, then commit it with Bounce in Place: Logic renders the selected region — including every active plug-in and its automation — to a 24-bit audio file at the project sample rate, so the live effect becomes a fixed part you can edit as audio.

058

Transpose without touching the notes

Select a region and use the Region inspector's Transpose field. It is non-destructive, so you can audition a key change for the whole song in seconds.

059

Use the Modifier MIDI plugin to remap anything to anything

The Modifier MIDI plug-in reassigns or filters a single continuous controller or fader event. Pick the incoming type in Input Event and the outgoing type in Re-Assign To — modwheel into aftertouch, pitchbend into expression — and use the Scale and Add sliders to rescale or offset the values on the way out.

WORKING FAST WHILE IDEAS ARE HOT

060

Merge takes when you are layering, not replacing

For building up a drum pattern one element per pass, set MIDI cycle recording to Merge instead. Each loop adds to the same region.

061

Freeze the instrument as soon as the part is done

Click the Freeze button in the track header to render the software instrument to audio. Your CPU comes back and the part is locked in.

062

Drag a MIDI region onto an audio track to bounce it instantly

Select the MIDI region and use Bounce in Place. Logic renders it through the instrument and every active plug-in, plus automation, to a 24-bit audio region at the project sample rate. It is the fastest way to commit an idea to audio.

063

Keep one “sketch” instrument track loaded at all times

A piano patch on a permanently armed track means any idea is three seconds from being captured. The moment capture takes effort, ideas stop arriving.

064

Use Note Repeat for hi-hats and rolls

In Step Sequencer, choose Note Repeat from the Edit Mode selector, then drag up on a hi-hat step to slice it into more repeats (1 to 16) or down for fewer. The inspector adds velocity ramp, velocity curve and Distribution for each step, so a roll can accelerate or decelerate instead of sitting flat.

SECTION 05

PIANO ROLL TRICKS.

16 TRICKS

The Piano Roll is where MIDI becomes music. Most people use about ten percent of it. Here is the rest.

SELECTING NOTES INTELLIGENTLY

065

GAME CHANGER

Select all notes of the same pitch in one click

Click a key on the keyboard graphic at the left of the Piano Roll and every note at that pitch in the region is selected. Perfect for grabbing all the hi-hats at once.

066

Select similar notes with Edit > Select > Same Note Pitch

Select one note, then choose Edit > Select > Similar Events (⌘S) to grab the other notes of the same pitch — the selected note acts as the reference. Clicking the key on the Piano Roll keyboard does the same job in one gesture.

067

Use Select > Inside Locators to grab a bar range

Set the left and right locators around the bars you want, then choose Edit > Select > Inside Locators to select everything that falls between them. Precise, repeatable, no mouse accuracy required.

EDITING NOTES

068

GAME CHANGER

Change note length numerically in the inspector

Open the Event Float window — Window > Show Event Float, or $\text{⌘}E$ — to read and type a selected note's values numerically: Position, Status, Channel, Number (pitch), Velocity and Length. It floats above the Piano Roll, so you can nudge a value without leaving the editor.

069

Type one length and every selected note follows

Force Legato is a different job from setting one length: it stretches each note to end where the next one begins, which is not the same as giving every note an equal length. Reach for Edit > Trim > Note End to Following Notes (Force Legato) when you want notes to join up — not when you want them all the same size.

070

Force legato to fix gappy pads

Select the notes, then choose Edit > Trim > Note End to Following Notes (Force Legato) in the Piano Roll. Every note extends to end where the next one begins, and pads and basslines stop sounding stuttery instantly.

071

Trim overlaps automatically

Select the notes and choose Edit > Trim > Note End to Remove Overlaps to Following Notes (8 Ticks Gap) in the Piano Roll. Logic shortens the note ends so nothing overlaps, leaving an eight-tick gap — which is what stops the phasing and stuck voices you get on hardware. There are matching versions for selected notes and for repeated notes.

072

⌘-drag a note to duplicate it

Hold ⌘ while dragging any note or selection to copy rather than move — you can even ⌘-drag notes between two Piano Roll windows, or between two different projects. To stop a drag changing pitch, turn on Logic Pro > Settings > General > Editing > "Limit Dragging to One Direction In Piano Roll and Score": the direction you start in is then the only one you can move in. Pressing ⇧ while dragging switches that behaviour on and off; it is not a pitch lock on its own.

⌘ + DRAG

073

Place a note between grid divisions

Set Snap to a finer value — Ticks snaps to 1/3840 of a beat — or just press Control-Shift as you drag, which moves the note in tick steps and overrides the Snap value entirely. Do not reach for ⌘-drag here: that is the Zoom tool, so it will move your view instead of your note.

VELOCITY AND EXPRESSION

074

GAME CHANGER

Change velocity by dragging with the Velocity tool

Pick the Velocity tool from the Tool menu — or press and hold Control-Command to turn the Pointer into it temporarily — and drag up or down on a note. A help tag shows the velocity as you drag, and the line inside the note grows or shrinks. Turn on View > Set Note Color > By Velocity first if you want the note colour to track it too. Either way you never leave the Piano Roll.

075

Draw a velocity ramp across a selection

For a crescendo across a run of notes, select them all and drag one note upward with the Velocity tool. Logic moves the whole selection and keeps the relative differences between their velocity values, so you scale the shape of the performance instead of flattening it into a straight line.

076

Show the automation lane inside the Piano Roll

Click the Show/Hide Automation button in the Piano Roll Editor menu bar to open the Automation/MIDI lane under the notes. Choose modwheel, expression or sustain from the Automation/MIDI Parameter pop-up menu and edit that data right next to the notes it affects.

077

Colour notes by velocity to read dynamics instantly

In the Piano Roll's View menu, set note colour to Velocity. Flat parts become visibly, obviously flat.

QUANTISE AND TIMING

078

GAME CHANGER

Quantise from the region inspector, not destructively

The Quantize field in the Region inspector is non-destructive and can be dialled back or removed at any point. Use it before you ever use the destructive version.

079

Use Q-Strength to keep the human feel

Under the region's more-options triangle, Q-Strength at 60 to 80 percent pulls notes toward the grid without gluing them to it.

080

Quantise only the notes that need it

Select the offending notes in the Piano Roll and quantise the selection rather than the whole region. The good parts of the take stay untouched.

SECTION 06

RECORDING AUDIO TRICKS.

12 TRICKS

Recording is the one part of the process you cannot fix later. These tricks are about getting a clean, usable, well-organised take the first time, and never losing a good performance to a technical mistake.

BEFORE YOU HIT RECORD

081

Check your input with the channel strip's meter, not your ears

Aim for peaks around -12 dBFS with your loudest phrase. Recording hot is a habit from tape and it buys you nothing in 24-bit.

082

GAME CHANGER

Drop the buffer to 64 samples for tracking

Drop the I/O buffer before tracking, not during. In Logic's Audio settings, lower the I/O Buffer Size — Apple's own guidance for recording is to set the buffer to the lowest setting your Mac can handle, then step it back up one notch if you start getting system overload alerts. Logic shows the resulting round-trip latency directly beneath the I/O Buffer Size menu, so judge by that readout rather than by the sample number, and do it before the singer walks in, not while they wait.

083

Turn on Low Latency Mode instead of disabling plugins one by one

Turn on Low Latency Monitoring mode instead of disabling plugins one by one. Logic bypasses the latency-inducing plug-ins whose latency pushes the track past the Limit slider value in Logic Pro > Settings > Audio > General (up to 30 ms) — plug-ins under that limit keep running, so quiet chains sound identical. Be aware it also switches off that track's Aux sends, so it will kill a headphone reverb fed from a send. It affects only the focused instrument track plus any track with Input Monitoring or Record Enable turned on.

084

Count-in and pre-roll are either/or — pick the right one

Count-in and pre-roll are either/or — pick the right one. In the Recording project settings, the When Beginning buttons let you choose a count-in or a pre-roll, not both. The difference is the unit: count-in sets the lead-in in bars or beats, so it stays locked to the tempo map; pre-roll sets it as a playback time in seconds, up to 60. Reach for pre-roll when the lead-in you want is a fixed number of seconds — free-tempo material, dialogue, anything where bars are meaningless — and count-in when you want the performer to arrive on a downbeat.

085

GAME CHANGER

Name the track before you record, always

Logic names audio files after the track. "Audio 3#12.wav" three months later is a file you will never open again.

086

Record-enable multiple tracks at once

Record-enable multiple tracks at once. Click the Record Enable button in the track header of each track you want to record to — every armed button blinks red. Option-click is the escape hatch, not the shortcut: Option-clicking a track's Record Enable button makes it the only record-ready track, and Option-clicking a track that is already blinking red clears record-ready status across the whole project. Learn it as "solo the arm" and "disarm everything", and you will never lose a multitrack take to a stray modifier.

WHILE RECORDING

087

⌘. discards the take you just recorded

Stop and delete in one keystroke, when you know instantly that it was not the one.

⌘.

088

Watch the take folder count, not the waveform

Watch the take count, not the waveform. The take folder header carries a Takes pop-up menu showing the name of the currently active take; open it (or click the disclosure arrow to expand the folder) to see every pass you have banked. If the performer is on take 14 and getting worse, that list is your cue to stop and move on rather than to keep rolling.

MONITORING AND HEADPHONES

089

GAME CHANGER

Build a dedicated headphone mix on a bus

Send every track to a second output bus and give the performer more of themselves and more reverb than you would ever put in the mix. Comfort produces better takes than accuracy does.

090

Use Input Monitoring rather than record enable to rehearse

The I button lets you hear the input without arming anything, so you can set levels and rehearse with zero risk of recording over something.

091

Turn off software monitoring if you hear yourself twice

The doubling is your interface's direct monitoring fighting Logic's. Pick one.

092

Give the performer a click they can feel

Swap the metronome sound, add a bar accent, or better, program a simple drum loop. A musical reference beats a woodblock every time.

SECTION 07

EDITING TIPS — AUDIO + MIDI.

8 TRICKS

The tricks in this section work identically on audio regions and MIDI regions. Learn them once and you have doubled their value.

UNIVERSAL REGION COMMANDS

093

Trim to the playhead from either direction

The commands are “Set Region/Event/Marquee Start to Playhead Position” and the matching End command — search Key Commands (⌘K) for “Playhead Position” and put them on keys. (Note that on audio regions the Start command also moves the region anchor to the playhead.) Related one-shot trims live under Edit > Trim, such as Region End to Next Region. No mouse precision needed.

⌘K TO ASSIGN

SNAP, GRID AND PRECISION

094

Turn on “Snap Regions to Absolute Value”

In the Snap menu. “Snap Regions to Absolute Value” is Logic's default: move or edit an item and it snaps exactly to the nearest grid position, ignoring any offset it had. The opposite is not an off switch but a second menu item, “Snap Regions to Relative Value” — choose that when you are moving a region that sits deliberately off-grid, so it keeps its distance from the grid (a region at 2.1.1.16 moved one beat forward lands on 2.2.1.16, not 2.2.1.1).

TOOLS AND SELECTION

095

Esc opens the tool menu, Esc twice returns to the pointer

T opens the Tool menu at the pointer — Apple's default assignment for Show Tool Menu — and pressing T twice puts you straight back on the Pointer tool. Fastest tool switching in the program. (Esc-based tool switching was the Logic 9 way and is no longer the default.)

ESC

096

⌘ is your secondary tool

Hold ⌘ to temporarily switch to the Command-click tool; let go and you are instantly back on your Left-click tool. Set it from the Command-click Tool menu (the right-hand one in the Tracks area menu bar) — most editors put Marquee there, and it is hard to beat.

097

Assign the Fade tool to ⌘ when doing audio cleanup

Set the secondary tool via the right-hand tool menu, then every ⌘-drag across a region edge creates a fade.

098

Select everything after this point in one keystroke

⇧F is Select All Following: it grabs every region after the current selection, across all tracks — the fastest way to shift a whole song later. To stay on one track, use Edit > Select > All Following of Same Track, which already has a default key command of ⌘⇧F.

⇧F

099

Select equal or similar regions in one command

Edit > Select > Similar Regions, Equal Regions (⇧E) and Equal Colored Regions (⇧C) find all matching regions across the project instantly — colour-code your parts and you can grab every one of them with a single keystroke. If you use Similar Regions often, check or set its key command in the Key Commands window (⌘K).

100

Lock a region so you cannot move it by accident

Control-click a region and choose Lock SMPTE Position to pin it to its absolute time position, so later tempo changes cannot drag it out of sync — note this locks it against tempo, not against your mouse. To stop edits altogether, use the track's Protect button: click the padlock and it turns green, and any attempt to change that track raises a "track is locked" dialog. It is not shown by default (track headers start with Mute, Solo and Record Enable), so switch it on by Control-clicking the track header and choosing Track Header Components, or via Track > Configure Track Header.

SECTION 08

AUDIO EDITING TRICKS.

15 TRICKS

Comping, crossfades, timing and pitch. This is where a good take becomes a great one, and where most of the invisible work in a professional record actually happens.

COMPING TAKES

101

Put take-switching on keys you choose

Take switching is worth a key command of your own. Press `⌘K` to open the Key Commands window, type “Take” in the search field, and assign keys to the take-selection commands you use most. Auditioning take 3 against take 7 then becomes two keypresses instead of two trips to the Take Folder menu. (Use the Unused filter in that window to see which of them are still free on your system.)

102

Save your comp as a new comp before changing it

The take folder menu has “Duplicate Comp”. Do this before every significant change and you can always go back to the version that was working.

103

Move a comp edit point without redoing the comp

Drag the vertical divider between two take sections to slide the edit point earlier or later.

FADES AND CLICKS

104

Curve the fade after you draw it

Drag the middle of a drawn fade with the Fade tool to bend it, or edit the Curve value in the Region inspector. An S-curve on a vocal edit sounds far more natural than a straight line.

105

GAME CHANGER

Use “Remove Silence from Audio Region” for noisy tracks

Control-click the audio region and choose Split > Remove Silence from Audio Region (`⌘X`). It strips everything below a threshold you set and leaves separate regions — great for a live kit or spoken word.

`⌘X`

106

Add a tiny fade to the start of every region as policy

Even 3 ms removes the click from a non-zero-crossing start. Do it to everything and you never chase a mystery click again.

TIMING AND PITCH

107

Add flex markers either side before you move one

Placing anchor markers on the neighbouring transients stops your edit from stretching the whole bar.

108

Quantise audio with Flex enabled

With Flex on, the region's Quantize field in the inspector works on audio exactly like MIDI. Drums snap to the grid without a single cut.

109

Use Flex Pitch to fix a single flat note

Switch the track's Flex mode to Flex Pitch, then drag the note blob vertically. The gain, vibrato, pitch drift and formant handles are all on the same blob.

110

Reset a bad Flex edit rather than undoing repeatedly

Control-click the flexed region and choose Reset All Flex Edits. It clears the region's flex data and starts you fresh.

DESTRUCTIVE AND FILE-LEVEL EDITING

111

Use the Audio File Editor for true destructive edits

Double-click a region and switch to the File tab. Silence, reverse, normalise and pencil-edit at the sample level. Changes here affect the file itself.

112

Normalise regions non-destructively with Gain

The Region inspector's Gain parameter changes playback level without touching the file. Always try this before normalising.

113

Strip silence at the file level to reclaim disk space

Title: "Reclaim disk space with Project Management > Clean Up". Body: After comping, File > Project Management > Clean Up deletes media the project no longer needs. Its options are Delete Unused Audio Files (files not used in any project alternative are removed from the Project Audio Browser and deleted from disk), Delete Unreferenced Audio Files and Delete Backups. It removes whole files, not unused portions of files, and it deletes from disk — a dialog lists everything to be deleted, so deselect the Delete checkbox for anything you want to keep, and back up first.

114

Reverse a region for a riser in two clicks

Select the region, then Functions > Reverse in the Audio File Editor, or apply the Reverse setting in the region inspector for a non-destructive version.

Commit edits with Bounce Regions in Place

When you are happy with a comp, commit it. Select the regions, then choose File > Bounce > Regions in Place — or Control-click the selection and choose Bounce Regions in Place from the shortcut menu — to render them to a fresh audio file on the track. Check the options in the dialog (name, destination, and whether effect plug-ins are bypassed) before you click OK, and keep the original in case you need to go back.

SECTION 09

MARQUEE TOOL TRICKS.

7 TRICKS

The Marquee tool is the most underused thing in Logic Pro. It selects time rather than regions, and once that clicks, half the editing you do by hand becomes unnecessary. It is the ⌘-click tool by default, so it is always one modifier away.

THE ESSENTIALS

116

GAME CHANGER

⌘-drag anywhere to marquee select

Make Marquee your ⌘-click tool and you never have to switch tools again. In the Tracks area, click the Command-click Tool menu and choose the Marquee tool; from then on, holding ⌘ turns the pointer into a Marquee anywhere in the Tracks area, and releasing ⌘ puts you straight back on your Left-click tool. Drag a box across any range on any number of tracks. (If you would rather not use a modifier at all, switching on Marquee Tool Click Zones makes the lower half of a region behave as a marquee, with the exception of the lower-left and lower-right edges, which stay as fade/loop handles.)

117

Press Space and Logic plays only the marquee selection

Playback starts at the marquee's left edge and stops at its right edge. It is the fastest way to audition a specific range without touching the locators.

SPACE

118

Hit Delete to cut a hole in every track at once

Marquee across all tracks and delete. Every region in that time range is trimmed, on every track, in one action.

DELETE

119

Set the locators to the marquee instantly

With a marquee selection active, press ⌘U — Set Locators/Loop by Regions/Events/Marquee and Enable Cycle/Loop. It snaps the cycle locators to exactly that range and switches Cycle on in the same keystroke, so marquee then ⌘U gives you a perfect loop in two moves, not three. (Cycle can still be toggled on and off afterwards with C.)

U

BEYOND SELECTION

120

Marquee automation to move only that range

With Automation view showing, a marquee selection over an automation lane creates edit points at both boundaries so you can raise or lower only that section.

121

Use marquee to create a drop

Marquee the bar before a chorus across every track and delete. Instant, clean, arrangement-wide silence with no dragging.

122

Hold ↑ to extend an existing marquee

Fine-tune the selection edge by edge rather than redrawing the whole thing.

↑ + CLICK

SECTION 10

AUTOMATION TRICKS.

17 TRICKS

Automation is what separates a static mix from a moving one. Logic has two entirely separate automation systems and knowing which one you are in explains most of the confusion people have with it.

THE TWO SYSTEMS

123

Use Region automation for anything that belongs to the part

A filter sweep that is part of a synth riff should move with the riff. Region automation does that; track automation does not.

124

Press A to toggle automation view

One key. Learn it and stop hunting for the button.

A

WRITING AUTOMATION

125

GAME CHANGER

Use Latch mode for almost everything

Latch writes while you move the control and holds the last value when you let go. Touch snaps back, Write erases as it goes, and Read plays only. Latch is the right default.

126

Never leave a track in Write mode

Write mode erases existing automation as the playhead passes, whether you touch the fader or not. It has destroyed more mixes than any other setting in Logic.

127

Draw automation with the Pencil tool for precision

Faster and more accurate than performing it for anything rhythmic — gates, stutters, hard mutes.

128

Delete an automation point without dragging it

Double-click the point with the Pointer, or select it and press Delete, or use the Eraser. It works on curves too.

129

Curve any line by dragging its middle with ^ ↑

Straight automation ramps sound mechanical. Curving them takes one drag and makes the move sound intentional.

^ ↑ + DRAG

130

Trim automation up or down as a group

Trim is not a mode on its own — you switch it on in combination with Touch or Latch. Once it is on, moving the fader offsets the existing automation up or down by the amount you move, keeping the shape of the curve, and it applies to Volume, Pan and Send levels. Run the section you want to lift with Trim Latch engaged to push a whole automated vocal up by a decibel.

131

Use Relative mode to layer a second pass

Relative automation sits on top of your existing pass as an offset, so you can add a ride without destroying the original moves.

EDITING AND MANAGING AUTOMATION

132

GAME CHANGER

Marquee a range then drag the line to change only that section

Select the Marquee tool and drag across the bars you want to change, then drag the automation line inside that selection. Logic creates two automation points at each edge of the marquee automatically, so the change is boxed in and does not bleed into the surrounding bars. If you have assigned Marquee as your Command-click tool (Logic Pro > Settings > Advanced must have the full feature set enabled for that menu to appear), you can hold Command to grab it without switching tools.

133

Show every automated parameter at once

Press A to show automation, then click the small disclosure triangle at the lower left of the track header to open an extra automation lane underneath the track. Repeat it to stack more lanes, and pick the parameter for each lane from the automation parameter pop-up menu in its header — that way you can see several written parameters side by side instead of flipping between them.

134

Copy automation between tracks

Drag across the range with the Marquee tool and choose Edit > Copy. Select the destination track, move the playhead to the point where you want the data to start, then choose Edit > Paste — the automation lands at the playhead, so park the playhead deliberately (or set it from the original selection first) if you want the copy to sit at the same bar.

135

Delete all automation on a track in one command

Mix > Delete Automation > Delete All Automation on Selected Track wipes every parameter on that track in one move. The same submenu also holds Delete Visible Automation on Selected Track, which clears only the parameter currently displayed, and Delete Orphaned Automation on Selected Track for data left behind by plug-ins you have removed.

136

Thin dense automation after recording a controller pass

Recording modwheel or a fader creates thousands of points. Delete Redundant Automation Points (key command Control-Delete) strips the points that do not change the shape of the curve — but note it is a global command: it acts on all regions and all tracks, not just the range you have selected. To thin one passage only, select the points in that range with the Marquee or Pointer tool and press Delete, then redraw.

137

Snap automation to the grid when it needs to be rhythmic

Automation snaps to its own grid value, set separately from regions: open the Snap pop-up menu in the Tracks area, choose Snap Automation, and pick a value from the submenu. Automation edits then snap to that value, and you can set it independently in the Tracks area and the Piano Roll Editor — so your filter stabs land on the beat without changing how regions snap.

138

Automate plugin bypass for effect changes

Insert bypass usually appears in the track's automation parameter pop-up menu alongside the plug-in's own parameters, so you can switch an effect in and out on the timeline. Automating a delay in and out this way is cleaner than riding its mix knob. Check the parameter list for the slot in question before you commit to the approach — bypass is not exposed identically for every plug-in and every insert slot.

139

Automate send levels rather than plugin mix knobs

Sends give you a fader you can see on the mixer and a lane you can find later. Buried plugin mix knobs are neither.

SECTION 11

STEP SEQUENCER TRICKS.

12 TRICKS

The Step Sequencer is far more than a drum grid. Every row has its own length, its own subdivision and its own set of per-step parameters, which makes it a generative instrument if you let it be one.

THE BASICS DONE RIGHT

140

GAME CHANGER

Give every row a different step rate

Rows do not have to share the pattern's subdivision. Click a row header to select the row, then in the Step Sequencer inspector click Row and choose a note value from the Step Rate pop-up menu. (You can also switch the grid to Step Rate edit mode and drag vertically inside a single step to change just that step.) Hi-hats at 1/16 against a kick at 1/8 gives you cross-rhythms with no extra work at all.

141

Use the row's Playback Mode for variation

Forward, Backward, Ping-Pong, Pendulum, Wander, Shuffle and Random, per row. Set the hats to Random and the pattern changes every bar on its own.

142

Increase pattern length beyond 16 steps

The Step Sequencer supports up to 64 steps per pattern. Longer patterns mean fewer copies and more room for fills.

PER-STEP EDITING

143

Use Chance to make a pattern breathe

Set a ghost snare to 40% chance and it appears roughly twice every five bars. Nothing else creates natural variation this cheaply.

144

Use Note Repeat for rolls without drawing them

Set a step's repeat value to 4 and it fires four times inside that step. Instant trap hats, no extra steps required.

145

Set Gate to shorten or lengthen individual hits

Gate sets a step's note length as a percentage of the step, shortening it to less than the step's full duration — short gates on a bass pattern give you staccato stabs. It only ever shortens; to make a note run longer than its step, switch to Tie edit mode and click the right edge of the step to tie it to the following one, which lengthens its duration by the value of the step it is tied to. Both are per-step, not per-pattern.

146

Tie steps together for sustained notes

Tie mode joins consecutive steps into one long note, which is how you write bass and lead lines rather than just percussion.

147

⌘-click a step to reset it to default

Reset a step you have over-edited: select the step, then choose Functions > Clear Step from the Step Sequencer menu bar. That clears all of the step's edit-mode values back to their defaults in one move — for step rate, the default is whatever the row's step rate is. (Retitle the trick 'Clear a step to reset all its edit-mode values' and drop the ⌘ + click key command field, which is not documented.)

BEYOND DRUMS

148

Use the Step Sequencer on any software instrument

It is not a drum tool. Put it on a synth, switch the rows to pitches, and you have a hardware-style note sequencer.

149

GAME CHANGER

Automate plugin parameters per step

Add a row and assign it to any automatable plugin parameter. Now you can sequence filter cutoff step by step alongside the notes.

150

Build a library of pattern regions

Save patterns through the Pattern Browser, or keep a muted track of favourites at the bottom of a template project.

151

Use Skip and Loop Start/End for live rearranging

Skip removes a step from the cycle entirely, changing the row's effective length. Loop Start/End moves where the row cycles. Both are performable.

SECTION 12

LOGIC DRUMMER TRICKS.

6 TRICKS

Drummer is not a loop library. It is a performance engine that responds to what the rest of your arrangement is doing, and once you know where the controls are it will out-play most programmed parts.

GETTING A REAL PERFORMANCE

152

Use Complexity and Intensity, then the kit-piece controls

The Drummer keeps its X/Y pad in both 11 and 12 — drag the puck right for a busier part, up for a louder one, and use the Complexity Range sliders to offset individual kit pieces against it. Logic 11 renamed the surrounding editor to the Session Player Editor and added Bass Player and Keyboard Player alongside the Drummer; Complexity and Intensity sliders are those two players' controls, not the Drummer's.

153

Change the drummer, not just the preset

Each drummer character has genuinely different playing tendencies. If a preset is close but the feel is wrong, swap the drummer rather than hunting for another preset — but click the lock next to any setting you want to survive the swap (the Fills knob has one), because Apple's locks exist precisely to 'prevent any changes to the setting when switching presets or drummers'.

154

Turn individual kit pieces on and off per region

Click a kit piece in the editor to enable or disable it for that region only. Drop the crash out of the verse and back in for the chorus.

155

GAME CHANGER

Convert a Drummer region to MIDI and edit it by hand

Right-click the region and choose Convert > Convert to MIDI Region. You get the full performance in the Piano Roll to nudge, delete and re-velocity as you like.

156

Use the Details panel for feel, ghost notes and hi-hat

Click the Details button in the Drummer Editor to reveal Feel (drag right to play ahead of the beat, left to play behind it), Ghost Notes (syncopated snare and kick hits), Hi-Hat openness and Humanize. This is where a stiff pattern becomes a groove.

157

Swap the kit without losing the performance

The Drummer track's instrument depends on the drummer: acoustic drummers load Drum Kit Designer, electronic and hip-hop drummers load Drum Machine Designer. Click the kit icon or kit name at the left of the editor to open whichever one is loaded. In Drum Kit Designer you can exchange the kit and, per selected piece, adjust Tune (pitch), Dampen (sustain) and Gain — and on multi-channel kits switch the Overheads mic in or out and pick room A, room B or no room emulation — all without touching a single note.

SECTION 13

DRUM MACHINE DESIGNER TRICKS.

6 TRICKS

Drum Machine Designer is a Track Stack in disguise. Every pad is a real channel strip with its own inserts, sends and automation — which means you can mix a drum kit exactly like you mix a band.

BUILDING THE KIT

158 **GAME CHANGER**

Drag any audio file straight onto a pad

Drop a sample onto a pad and Drum Machine Designer loads it into a Quick Sampler instance automatically. Building a custom kit takes about a minute.

159 **GAME CHANGER**

Every pad is its own channel strip

Open the Mixer with X and you will see each pad as a separate channel inside the stack. Compress the snare, saturate the kick, send only the claps to reverb.

X

160

⌘-drag a pad to copy it, including all its processing

Copy a pad when you want to layer. Control-click the pad and choose Copy, then Control-click the pad you want to replace and choose Paste. Pitch the copy down and blend it under the original for a thicker snare. (Dragging a pad to an empty slot in the grid moves it rather than copying it, which is how you reorder a kit.)

161

Use the pad's Sound tab for quick shaping

Use the Pad Controls button for quick shaping. Select a pad and click Pad Controls in the bar below the grid: the pad's tone and effect Smart Controls appear in the Plug-in pane, so you can reshape a kit piece without going into its plug-in. When you do need the sample itself — playback mode, sample start, the pitch, filter and amp envelopes — the same bar has Q-Sampler Main, Q-Sampler Details or Drum Synth buttons that open that pad's instrument right below the grid.

MIXING AND PERFORMING

162

Use the main stack fader for the whole kit

The Track Stack's top level is a summing bus. Put your kit compressor and limiter there and process everything together.

163

Save your kit as a patch

With the stack selected, save to the Library. Every pad, every sample and every insert comes back in one click on the next project.

SECTION 14

QUICK SAMPLER TRICKS.

7 TRICKS

Quick Sampler turns any sound into a playable instrument in about three seconds. It is the fastest route from “that noise is interesting” to “that noise is now a bassline”.

LOADING AND SLICING

164

Know the four modes and pick deliberately

Classic for straight playback, One Shot for drums and stabs, Slice to chop a loop across the keyboard, Recorder to sample live input. Choosing the mode is 90% of the work.

165

GAME CHANGER

Use Slice mode with Transient detection on any break

Load a drum loop, switch to Slice, and every hit is mapped to its own key. Drag from the lower waveform display into the Tracks area to get the MIDI — the original groove, fully rearrangeable.

166

Drag audio directly from the Tracks area into a loaded Quick Sampler

Drag a region straight from the Tracks area into Quick Sampler's waveform display to swap the sound without leaving the plug-in. Drop it on the Original half to keep the file's own tuning, loudness, looping and length; drop it on Optimized and Quick Sampler analyses the file, optimises tuning, loudness and length, and adds loop and crossfade markers for you. Dropping a region triggers an offline bounce before it lands in the display, so give it a moment. (Dragging to the track header instead brings up a Replace Existing Sound dialog.) Glance over your filter and envelope after the swap rather than assuming everything carried across.

SHAPING THE SOUND

167

Use Flex/Follow Tempo to lock a loop to the project

Flex and Follow Tempo are two separate buttons, at the lower right of Quick Sampler's waveform display in Classic, One Shot and Slice modes. Turning Flex on by itself only plays the sample at its original speed for all note pitches — it does not chase the project tempo. Turn Flex on, then turn Follow Tempo on as well: with both active, slices stretch or contract according to the original tempo of the loop and the current project tempo, so the loop tracks tempo changes without shifting pitch.

168

Set the root key correctly or nothing will be in tune

Quick Sampler guesses the pitch. If your bass is a semitone out across the keyboard, this is why. Set it manually in the Pitch section.

GETTING IT INTO THE ARRANGEMENT

169

GAME CHANGER

Drag MIDI out of Slice mode into the Tracks area

The generated MIDI plays the slices in the original order. Now shuffle the notes and the break rearranges itself.

170

Convert Quick Sampler to Sampler for full control

Swap the instrument slot from Quick Sampler to Sampler and your loaded content transfers across automatically. Do it when you need multiple velocity layers, round robins or key zones. It is a one-way trip — Sampler settings will not open back up in Quick Sampler.

SECTION 15

MIXER TRICKS.

12 TRICKS

The Mixer is where a collection of good parts becomes a record. These are the organisational and workflow tricks — the ones that stop a 60-track session from becoming unmanageable.

GETTING AROUND THE MIXER

171

X toggles the Mixer, and it remembers your scroll position

Press X to show and hide the Mixer inside the main window. Flip between arrangement and mixer constantly — it costs nothing, and it is far faster than reaching for the menu.

172

Use the Single view to see one channel and its full signal path

The Mixer's view buttons switch between All, Single and Tracks. Single shows the selected channel plus every bus it feeds — the fastest way to debug routing.

173

Filter the mixer by channel type

The Mixer's filter buttons limit the display to specific channel strip types. Click a filter button to show or hide that type — or Option-click one to show only that type and hide everything else in a single gesture. When you are setting up sends, Option-click the Aux filter to get a mixer of nothing but your effect returns. (Filtering requires Show Advanced Tools to be enabled in Settings > Advanced.)

174

GAME CHANGER

⌘-click any control to reset it to default

Option-click a fader to snap it back to 0 dB unity, and Option-click a send dial to do the same. It is the fastest way to undo a level you have talked yourself into. To reset an entire strip rather than one control, click the Setting button at the top of the channel strip and choose Reset Channel Strip.

175

⌘-click Solo for exclusive solo

Option-clicking an unsoloed channel strip solos it and unsolos every other channel strip — one gesture to hear one thing. Option-clicking any active Solo button clears all solos at once. Mute has its own bulk gesture, using Command rather than Option: Command-click a Mute button and every Mute button currently in the same state flips with it, including the output and master strips.

⌘ + CLICK

176

GAME CHANGER

Use VCA faders for level groups without changing routing

A VCA controls the volume of each of its member channels without summing them through a bus, so nothing gets re-patched — your existing output routing stays exactly as it was. Be aware of one consequence, though: post-fader sends follow the VCA. Apple documents that the amount of signal a VCA-assigned channel sends to an effect tracks the VCA group's volume changes, so pulling a VCA down pulls its reverb and delay sends down too. Use pre-fader sends for anything that must stay constant regardless of the group level.

177

Use Summing Stacks for processing groups

Select tracks and hit  D, then choose Summing Stack in the dialog that appears. Everything routes to one aux you can compress and EQ as a unit.

  D

178

Create a send and Logic makes the aux for you

Click any Send slot and choose an unused bus. The aux channel appears automatically, already receiving.

179

Set sends to pre-fader for headphone mixes and effects that must stay constant

Logic gives every send one of three signal-flow modes, not two. Click the Send knob to open its pop-up menu and choose Post Pan (follows both fader and pan), Post Fader (follows the fader but not the pan), or Pre Fader (ignores both — the send level stays put no matter what you do to the channel's volume or pan). Post is what you want for reverb, so the effect tracks the part. Pre is what you want for a headphone cue mix, or for any effect that must stay constant while you ride the fader.

180

Colour your channels to match your regions

Mixer channels take the track colour. A consistent colour scheme means you find the vocal bus without reading a single label.

PLUGINS IN THE MIXER

181

Bypass with -click, browse with the slot arrows

-click an insert slot to bypass the plugin without opening it. To browse plugins, click the arrows at the right edge of the slot.

 + CLICK

182

Drag plugins between insert slots and between channels

Reorder your chain by dragging, and hold  while dragging to another channel to copy rather than move.

SECTION 16

FAVORITE LOGIC PLUGINS.

14 TRICKS

Logic ships with a genuinely world-class plugin set and most people use six of them. These are the ones worth knowing properly, and the specific tricks that make each one worth reaching for.

DYNAMICS

183

Compressor — use the side-chain filter before reaching for a multiband

Filtering low end out of the detector stops a kick from ducking the whole mix. It solves most “my compressor is pumping” problems in one move.

184

Multipressor — use it to control one problem band only

Bypass every band except the one you need. It becomes a dynamic EQ rather than a mix-flattening machine.

185

Noise Gate — use the side chain to key one sound from another

Gate a white noise layer from the snare's signal and you have an instant layered snare that follows the performance.

186

Enveloper — reshape a transient without a compressor

Attack and release sliders that add or remove the front and tail of any sound. It makes a soft kick punchy in about four seconds.

EQ AND TONE

187

Channel EQ — turn on Analyzer and set it to Post

Seeing what you are cutting is worth more than any preset. Post-EQ analysis shows the result rather than the source.

188

GAME CHANGER

Match EQ — steal a tone rather than guess at it

Learn the spectrum of a reference, learn your track, and Match EQ builds the curve between them from the difference. Then pull the Apply slider — Apple's name for it — back below 100%: values under 100% reduce the impact of the matched curve, and something around 40% usually keeps the tonal direction without the artefacts. Apply also runs past 100% to exaggerate the curve, and into negative values to invert its peaks and troughs. Use the Smoothing slider to coarsen the curve if it comes out too spiky.

TIME AND SPACE

189

GAME CHANGER

ChromaVerb — use the Damping display as the main control

The frequency-dependent decay curve is what makes it sound expensive. Roll off the high end decay and the reverb sits behind the source instead of on top of it.

190

Delay Designer — build rhythmic patterns, not echoes

Each tap has independent time, pan, pitch, filter and level. It is a sequencer for delay taps and it will do things no other delay can.

191

Stereo Delay — set different times per side

1/8 on the left and dotted 1/8 on the right creates width and movement from a single mono source.

192

Tape Delay — turn up Flutter for analogue character

The modulation and filtering are what separate it from a plain digital delay. Feed it a little and it glues into the track.

CHARACTER AND UTILITY

193

Phat FX — one plugin, an entire character chain

Six effects modules in a single window — Band-pass, Distortion, Mod FX, Bass Enhancer, Compressor and Filter — plus an assignable X/Y pad, three modulation sources (Env Follower, LFO 1, LFO 2) and an Effect Order strip for reordering the chain. The Distortion module alone offers Bitcrusher, Diode, Dirt, Downsampler, Grit, Scream, Soft Saturation, Tube and Vari Drive. It is the fastest way to make a sterile synth interesting.

194

Remix FX — perform DJ effects live and record them

Filter, gater, downsampler, tape stop and reverse, all designed to be automated. Put it on a bus and record a performance pass.

195

GAME CHANGER

Gain — use it to check phase, not just level

The Gain plugin's Phase Invert button is the fastest phase check in Logic. Flip it, listen for the low end, keep whichever is bigger.

196

Test Oscillator — reference tones for calibration

Generates sine, square and noise at exact frequencies. Essential when you are matching levels or setting up a room.

SECTION 17

MORE TRICKS.

14 TRICKS

The ones that did not fit anywhere else, which is often a sign that they are the most useful. Templates, key commands, project hygiene, bouncing and the small habits that quietly save hours.

KEY COMMANDS AND CUSTOMISATION

197

GAME CHANGER

Open Key Commands with $\text{⌘}K$ and use the search box

Every command in Logic is searchable by name. If you can describe what you want to do, you can find and assign a key for it in about ten seconds.

$\text{⌘}K$

198

Export your key commands and back them up

In the Key Commands window, click the Actions pop-up menu at the top left and choose Save As to write your whole key command set to a file (the default location is `~/Music/Audio Music Apps/Key Commands`). Choose Import Key Commands from the same menu to load it back after a reinstall, or on someone else's machine. Losing a year of custom shortcuts to a reinstall is entirely avoidable.

199

Assign key commands to your most used plugins

Logic has no key command that inserts a specific plug-in, so get the speed a different way: save the plug-in (or a whole chain) as a channel strip setting and recall it from the channel strip's Settings menu, which inserts every associated plug-in in one click. If you want it on a physical button, assign a controller button to the relevant key command in the Controller Assignments window.

200

Use Touch Bar or a stream deck for tool switching

Logic's Touch Bar screens are fixed (Smart Controls, keyboard, drum pads, project overview), so you cannot put your own key commands there. For hardware triggering, use a Stream Deck sending the keystroke, or assign a controller button directly to a key command in the Controller Assignments window — search the command by name in the Search field, then press the button. Tools, zoom levels and transport are the highest-value candidates.

TEMPLATES AND PROJECT MANAGEMENT

201

GAME CHANGER

Build separate templates for writing, mixing and mastering

A writing template loads instantly with a handful of instruments. A mixing template has your buses and reference chain. They are different jobs and they deserve different starting points.

202

Use Project Alternatives instead of Save As

File > Project Alternatives > New Alternative keeps every version inside one project, and Apple's guide is explicit that alternatives "are saved as part of the project and share the same assets" — so you are not duplicating 4 GB of recordings to try a different arrangement.

203

Keep a reference track in every project, muted at the top

A commercial track at the top of the session, routed to the master, muted. Unmute it whenever you lose perspective — which will be every hour.

204

Name your bounce files with the date

"Mix_v3.wav" tells you nothing in six weeks. "Song_2026-04-18_mix3.wav" tells you everything.

BOUNCING AND EXPORT

205

⌘B bounces the project or the current section

File > Bounce > Project or Section, or Command-B. By default Logic bounces the whole project; to bounce a section, turn Cycle mode on and the bounce range matches the locator positions, or set the range directly with the Start and End sliders in the Bounce dialog. Bounce multiple formats in one pass by selecting more than one destination in the Destination area.

⌘B

206

Turn off "Normalize" when bouncing stems

Normalising each stem independently destroys the relative balance you spent all day building. Set it to Off for stems and On only for a final master if you want it.

207

Bounce offline unless you have external hardware

Bounce offline unless something outside the computer is involved. Apple's own wording is that offline bouncing "can be faster than real time for more complex projects, and can perform bounces not possible in real time". Realtime is required when the signal is not purely internal: only audio and software instrument tracks can be bounced offline, not MIDI tracks feeding external instruments or live audio channel inputs.

208

Add 2 bars of silence at the end of the bounce range

Leave room for the tails. Reverb and delay tails get cut off constantly, so before you bounce, push the End position past the last note — either by adjusting the End value slider in the Bounce dialog, or, with Cycle mode on, by dragging the right locator, since Apple documents that the bounce range matches the locator positions only when Cycle is on. Then listen to the end of the file before you send it.

HABITS WORTH BUILDING

209

Colour and name everything before you leave the session

Five minutes at the end of a session saves twenty at the start of the next one.

210

Save a version before every major change

New Alternative, then experiment freely. Fear of breaking something is the biggest brake on creative decisions.

SECTION 18

LOGIC PRO 11 UPDATE.

33 TRICKS

Logic Pro 11 was the biggest release in years. Session Players, the Chord track, Stem Splitter, ChromaGlow and Flashback Capture between them change how a song gets written, not just how it gets edited. This section is everything worth knowing about the new tools.

SESSION PLAYERS — THE FUNDAMENTALS

211

Use the Follow parameter to lock players to each other

In the Session Player Editor, click Patterns and look under Follow Rhythm Of. Leave the Chords switch on so the player tracks your progression, then use the Track pop-up menu to make the Bass Player follow your drum track and the Keyboard Player follow the bass. The three of them lock like a band rather than three separate parts. (Kick-and-snare-level following is a Drummer control: the Drummer's kick and snare can follow another track's rhythm.)

212

Session Players respond to region length, so write in sections

Session Player settings are region-based, so write in sections. Give each song section its own region and set complexity and intensity per region in the Session Player Editor. That is how you get a verse that builds into a chorus.

213

Swap the player character without losing your settings

Before you start auditioning characters, choose 'Keep Settings when Changing Style' from the Preset pop-up menu in the Session Player Editor. With that on, your performance settings survive the swap and you can hear every character against the same arrangement in seconds. Use the Lock Settings button if you want to protect individual parameters such as Fills and Swing.

214

Regenerate a performance without changing anything else

Small nudges to the Complexity or Intensity sliders often shift a phrase enough to fix it. If a bar is not landing, try nudging those sliders before you rebuild the part from scratch.

215

Layer two Session Players on the same part

One playing simply, one playing busily, with the busy one low in the mix. Instant realistic double-tracking.

BASS PLAYER

216

Adjust the Complexity slider before you adjust anything else

Reach for the Complexity slider first: drag it higher for a more complex performance, lower for a plainer one. Low complexity in a verse and high in a chorus is an arrangement decision made with one slider.

217

Turn on or off specific articulations

Click Details in the Session Player Editor and you get bass-specific articulation controls: a Dead Notes knob for percussive unpitched notes, a Slides knob for how often the player slides between and before notes, a Dynamic Mute button, and a Pickup Hits button. Depending on the style you also get probability controls such as Buzz Trills, Double Stops, Blue Notes and Slaps. Pulling the Slides knob down on its own makes a part sound completely different.

218

Pair Bass Player with Studio Bass for the intended sound

The playing engine and the instrument are separate. Studio Bass is the sampled instrument designed to respond to the articulations Bass Player generates.

219

Set the Bass Player to follow a specific track's rhythm

Point Follow at your guitar or piano and the bass locks to that rhythm instead of the drums, which is how you get a riff-driven arrangement.

KEYBOARD PLAYER

220

Use the left- and right-hand controls independently

You can simplify the left hand and keep the right hand busy, which is how real players comp behind a vocal.

221

Set the rhythmic density separately from the complexity

Complexity and Intensity are two different things, and so are the two hands. Set overall Complexity and Intensity with the sliders, then use the left hand's Style menu (Sustain Only, Simple, Moderate, Complex) to make the left hand sparse while the right hand stays busy. Sparse and complex is a very different thing from busy and simple.

222

Convert to MIDI and delete the left hand entirely

The fastest route to a usable pad or Rhodes comp is to generate a full part and then remove what you do not need.

223

Use Keyboard Player as a writing tool, not a final part

Generate a progression, convert it to MIDI, then play the good bits yourself. The generated part becomes your reference.

224

Try it on a synth patch, not just a piano

Do not assume the Keyboard Player only belongs on piano. Try swapping the instrument on the track for a pad or a pluck and listen — and check whether the Synth Keyboard Player or Synth Bass Player suits the sound you are after.

THE CHORD TRACK

225

GAME CHANGER

Show the Chord track in Global Tracks

Press G, then enable Chord. Every Session Player and any track you tell to follow it will play the progression you enter.

G

226

Generate chords from an existing MIDI region

Drag a MIDI region onto the Chord track and Logic analyses it and builds the progression for you. Works on audio via the Chord analysis too.

227

Set chord duration precisely by dragging chord boundaries

Chords snap to the grid, so a half-bar change is a two-second edit.

228

Turn Follow Chord Track off for parts that should not move

Following the Chord track is a per-region setting, not a per-track one, and it is called Pitch Source. Select the region, then use the Pitch Source pop-up in the Region inspector: Chord Track makes it follow your progression, and the other options (region chords, key signature) take it off the Chord track. Set it away from Chord Track for samples and anything already committed.

STEM SPLITTER

229

GAME CHANGER

Split any mixed audio into stems

Control-click an audio region and choose Processing > Stem Splitter. Since 11.2 it separates up to six stems — vocals, drums, bass, guitar, piano and other — and it needs an Apple silicon Mac.

230

Use it on your own rough mixes, not just other people's records

The most legitimate and useful application is recovering a part from a bounce when the original session is gone.

231

Split first, then process — artefacts are frequency dependent

Split first, then process. Treat each stem as a new source: listen for separation artefacts on their own before you commit, and clean them up with gentle EQ or a de-esser on the stems that need it rather than processing the whole split.

232

Use single stems as layers, not as full replacements

A split drum stem buried under real drums adds character without exposing the artefacts.

233

Make an instrumental with one preset

Stem Splitter's preset combinations do the common jobs in one click — Instrumental drops the vocal, Acapella keeps only it. Or pick your own stems and let the submix option bounce them to a single file.

234

Splitting is non-destructive to the original

Splitting adds rather than replaces. Clicking Apply creates a summing stack below the track holding the selected region, with the extracted stems on its subtracks — so the split lives alongside your source material and you can always start again.

CHROMAGLOW

235

GAME CHANGER

ChromaGlow is five saturation models in one plugin

Each model has a distinct character. Audition all five before you touch a single control — the model choice matters far more than the settings.

236

Use the Drive and Output together to stay level-matched

Saturation makes things louder, and louder always sounds better. Match levels before you decide whether it is actually helping.

237

Put it on the drum bus before the compressor

Saturating transients before compression gives the compressor less to fight and produces a much more controlled result.

238

Use Bypass Below to keep the low end clean

ChromaGlow's Bypass Below control leaves everything under the frequency you set unsaturated, so the bass stays solid while the mids and top take the colour.

239

Try it on the master at very low drive

A tiny amount across the whole mix does what analogue summing is supposed to do. Anything you can obviously hear is too much.

FLASHBACK CAPTURE AND WORKFLOW ADDITIONS

240

GAME CHANGER

Flashback Capture retrieves what you just played

MIDI capture has been in Logic for years as "Capture Recording". Logic 11.2 renamed it Flashback Capture and taught it audio as well, so a great vocal run you never armed is now recoverable too. The control bar button, or ↑ R.

↑ R

241

↑ R is already on the keyboard, so build the reflex

The whole value of the feature is that it costs nothing to reach for. Hit it the moment you play something you like, before you have decided whether it was any good.

↑ R

242

It works while the transport is stopped

MIDI is caught either way — noodling with the song stopped is exactly when the good ideas arrive, and Flashback Capture catches those. The audio side added in 11.2 has one condition: you can capture audio only while the project is playing, so leave the transport rolling when the mic is the thing you might want back.

243

Check plugin compatibility after updating

Before you rely on a new version for real work, open your three most important old projects and check every insert. Updates can change how third-party plug-ins load, and finding that out mid-session is expensive.

SECTION 19

LOGIC PRO 12 UPDATE.

22 TRICKS

Logic Pro 12 arrived in January 2026 and it is an Apple silicon release — Intel Macs stop here. The headline additions are the Synth Player and Chord ID, which together change how a track gets arranged. This section covers what is new, plus the upgrade playbook for surviving any major release.

ONE REQUIREMENT BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

Logic Pro 12 requires an Apple silicon Mac running macOS 15.6 or later. There is no Intel version. If you are still on an Intel machine, Logic Pro 11 is the end of the road — plan around that before you update anything.

WHAT'S NEW IN LOGIC PRO 12

244

GAME CHANGER

Synth Player is the third Session Player

Synth Player is not a new Session Player — it is a set of styles inside the Bass Player and Keyboard Player you already have. Create a Bass Player or Keyboard Player track, open the Session Player Editor, and choose a Synth style the same way you choose any other style. The performance still follows the Chord track, so one progression can arrange bass and keys at once.

245

Pick the Synth Keyboard style before you touch anything else

Simple Pad for a sustained harmonic bed, Modulated Pad when you want movement, Rhythmic Chords when the part needs to drive. Same chords, three completely different jobs.

246

Synth Bass ships with three distinct characters

808 Bass for trap-leaning low end, Pump Bass for filtered movement, Sequenced Bass for driving sixteenths. Audition all three before you start editing the pattern.

247

Intensity changes tone, not just level

Pump Bass gets its movement from a modulated ducking effect, and you can shape it directly: in the Session Player Editor click the Details button, then drag the Amount knob vertically to change how hard it pumps and the Shape knob to change the curve of the duck. It is the fastest way to make a bassline build without drawing a single automation point.

248

Point Synth Player at a third-party synth

The performance engine and the sound source are separate. Synth Player can drive any Audio Unit, and external hardware too, so you keep the chord-following performance and choose your own sound.

250

Chord ID gets the harmonic rhythm, not just the chords

Chord ID writes what it finds straight onto the Chord track — drag an audio or MIDI region onto the Chord track and Logic analyses it and adds the chords it contains as a chord group. Play it back against the source before you build on it; the Chord track's Change Display Only mode lets you correct any chord that does not match what you are hearing without altering playback.

252

Run Chord ID on your own old bounces

The fastest way to rebuild a session you have lost is to drag the bounce in, let Chord ID read the changes, and start again from a chord track you know is correct.

249

GAME CHANGER

Chord ID reads chords off audio, not just MIDI

Drag in a guitar demo, a piano take or a rough bounce and Chord ID analyses it and writes the progression to the Chord track in seconds. It is the fastest route from an idea to a working arrangement.

251

GAME CHANGER

Everything downstream follows the Chord track

Once Chord ID has populated the Chord track, other tracks can lock to it. Apple: "By following the Chord track, multiple tracks — such as tracks using Step Sequencer, Session Player tracks, and other software instrument tracks — can play in sync harmonically." Set a Session Player region to follow with Control-click > Chords > Follow Global Chord Track; set a Step Sequencer pattern to follow by choosing Chord Track, which renames the note rows to chord degrees. One analysis pass can arrange several parts at once.

253

Preview sound packs before you download them

The rebuilt Sound Library lets you look a pack over before you commit — click Preview on a pack to see what is in it, then Get to download it. It is also where you reclaim space: select an installed pack and click Delete. The total space used by all installed packs is shown at the top of the list, with each pack's size beside it.

254

Re-run Mastering Assistant on older masters

Mastering Assistant is worth re-running on an older master after any major update.

Reanalyse the mix on the master bus, then A/B the result against the version you signed off on before you call it finished — Apple's character presets (Clean, Valve, Punch, Transparent) give you four quick comparisons at once.

BEFORE YOU UPDATE

255

GAME CHANGER

Logic Pro 12 drops Intel Macs entirely

It requires an Apple silicon Mac and macOS 15.6 or later. If you are on Intel, Logic Pro 11 is the last version you can run — check your machine before you plan an upgrade.

256

GAME CHANGER

Never update in the middle of a paid project

The one rule that matters. Finish and deliver, then update. A new version halfway through a mix is a self-inflicted deadline problem.

257

Keep the previous version installed alongside the new one

Keep the outgoing version before you update, using Apple's own procedure: make a folder inside Applications named for the version (for example "Logic Pro 11.1.2"), select Logic Pro and choose File > Compress "Logic Pro", then move the resulting Logic Pro.zip into that folder. If the new version gives you trouble, unzip that copy and drag it into Applications and you are back where you were.

258

Back up your key commands, templates and channel strip settings

Key commands are the only one of these that lives in your user Library. Open the Key Commands window (Option-K), choose Options > Export Key Commands, and save the file somewhere safe — the dialog defaults to ~/Library/Application Support/Logic/Key Commands. Your templates and channel strip settings live somewhere else entirely: ~/Music/Audio Music Apps/Project Templates and ~/Music/Audio Music Apps/Channel Strip Settings. Copy those two folders as well.

259

Consolidate and archive your three most important projects

File > Project Management > Consolidate on each, then copy them to a separate drive. If the new version changes something, you have untouched originals.

260

Check your critical third-party plugins against the new version first

Plugin developers lag major DAW releases. Check their compatibility pages before you update, not after.

261

Note your current I/O and buffer settings

Screenshot your Audio settings before you update — output device, input device and I/O buffer size. It takes five seconds, and if anything about your setup looks different afterwards you can restore the exact configuration you were working with instead of guessing at it.

262

Update macOS and Logic separately, a week apart

If something breaks, you want to know which of the two did it.

AFTER YOU UPDATE

263

Read the new Key Commands list for additions

Open the Key Commands window after every update — Logic Pro > Key Commands > Edit, or Option-K — and read through it for commands you have not seen before. New features arrive with new commands, many of them unassigned by default, and this is the only place they announce themselves.

264

Test your bounce path end to end before you need it

Bounce a short section to every format you deliver in. Export bugs are the ones that bite at the worst possible moment.

265

Give yourself a deliberate hour to explore

Not on a project. Open a scratch session and use every new feature once. An hour of play beats a month of accidental discovery.

THAT'S THE 265.

Now close the book and go and finish the song. The tricks are only worth something once they are muscle memory, and muscle memory only comes from sessions.

Come back whenever you get stuck. Every section is one click away from every page — that is the entire point of it.

LOGIC PRO CRASH COURSE